Functions:

- Vitamin D is required for normal growth in mammals. This is probably related to absorption and utilization of calcium and phosphorous.
- It helps in the normal development of bone and teeth.

Absorption and storage

- Vitamin D absorption occurs from small intestine. Fat and bile are essential for its absorption. Vitamin D enters into the general circulation via lymph and stored mainly in liver and kidneys.

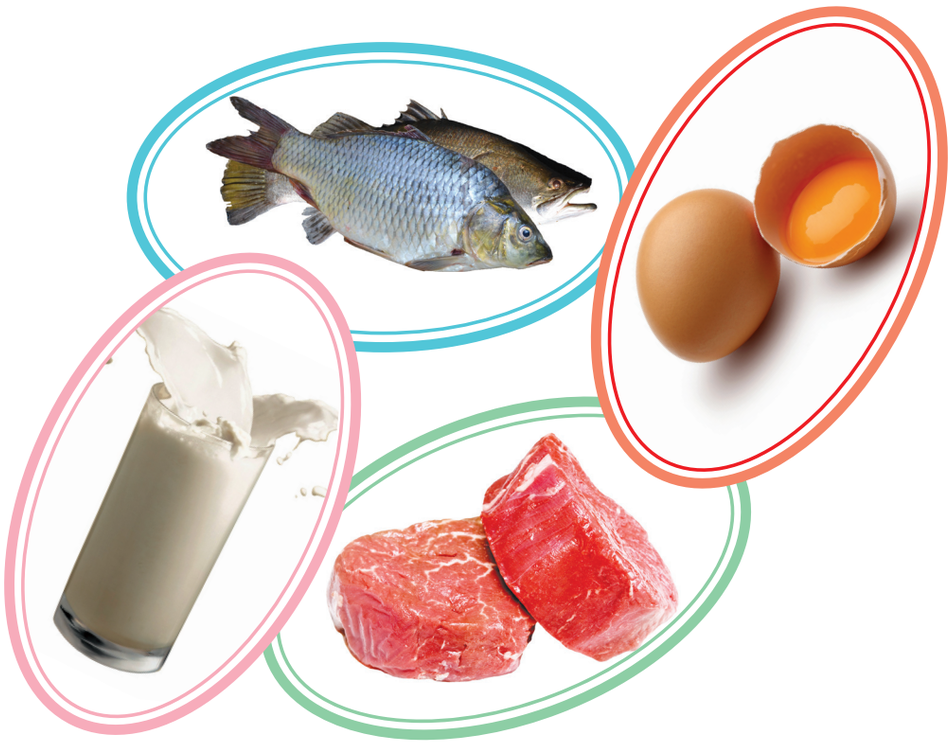


Figure 8.5 Sources of vitamin D

Deficiency:

Deficiency of this vitamin causes rickets in growing children and osteomalacia in adults (Fig. 8.6). It is due to softening of bones resulting from lack of calcium and phosphate.

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